Block practice · Memory

Work through each question type in order. Each section has a worked-example retry and all further practice. Attempt only the part outlined in red.

How memory works: stages of the memory process

How long and how much: duration and capacity

Peterson and Peterson (1959): how long STM lasts

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Practice workbook · How memory works: stages of the memory process

Input, processing, output and encoding, storage, retrieval.

4 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 3 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-MEM-01

1. Question 5 · part whole · 1 mark

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

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5 **Figure 3** shows the three stages of the memory process.

Complete **Figure 3** with the missing stage.



Figure 3

(Total for Question 5 = 1 mark)

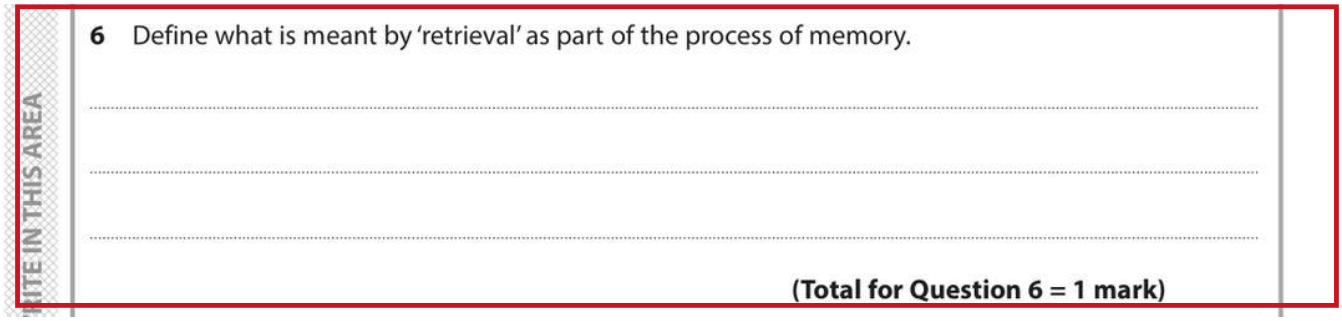
Working and answer

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2. Question 6 · part whole · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.


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6 Define what is meant by 'retrieval' as part of the process of memory.

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(Total for Question 6 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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3. Question 6 · part whole · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

6 Complete **Figure 2** with the missing stage.

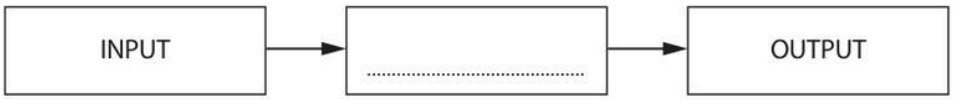


Figure 2

(Total for Question 6 = 1 mark)

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Working and answer

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4. Question 7 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

7 Identify which of the following would be the most appropriate to define the 'storage' stage of the memory process.

- ☒ **A** Recalling information
- ☒ **B** Keeping information
- ☒ **C** Noticing information
- ☒ **D** Selecting information

(Total for Question 7 = 1 mark)

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Working and answer

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Practice workbook · How long and how much: duration and capacity

Duration and capacity of short-term and long-term memory.

5 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 4 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-MEM-02

1. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

9 Nishka was interested in the amount of numbers that a person could remember over a short period of time.

She presented a group of participants with seven number lists. The number lists were shown one by one to the group. Each number list increased in length with each successive trial, up to a maximum of 10 numbers (see **Figure 3**).

Nishka's number lists

Trial 1:	**8**	**1**	**5**	**0**					
Trial 2:	**4**	**2**	**3**	**9**	**6**				
Trial 3:	**3**	**8**	**1**	**0**	**4**	**5**			
Trial 4:	**2**	**7**	**1**	**5**	**6**	**9**	**1**		
Trial 5:	**5**	**0**	**2**	**1**	**7**	**3**	**8**	**4**	
Trial 6:	**0**	**2**	**9**	**1**	**3**	**0**	**4**	**7**	**5**
Trial 7:	**1**	**6**	**2**	**7**	**8**	**4**	**1**	**3**	**5**	**2**

Figure 3

At the end of each trial, participants had to write down the numbers in the order that they saw them. Participants only continued to the next trial if they successfully completed the previous trial.

(a) Explain, using your knowledge of the capacity of short-term memory, what Nishka is likely to find.

(2)

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1. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **one** improvement Nishka could make to her study.

(2)

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(Total for Question 9 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

2. Question 7 · part a · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

7 Toby has collected 10 different types of dinosaur. He is trying to remember the names of all the dinosaurs he has collected.

Define what is meant by the following terms in relation to Toby's memory of his dinosaurs.

(a) Duration

(1)

(b) Capacity

(1)

(Total for Question 7 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

3. Question 7 · part b · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

7 Toby has collected 10 different types of dinosaur. He is trying to remember the names of all the dinosaurs he has collected.

Define what is meant by the following terms in relation to Toby's memory of his dinosaurs.

(a) Duration

(1)

.....

.....

.....

(b) Capacity

(1)

.....

.....

.....

(Total for Question 7 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

4. Question 6 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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6 State **one** feature of each of the following as part of short-term memory.

Duration

Capacity

(Total for Question 6 = 2 marks)

Working and answer

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5. Question 6 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

6 Identify which of the following would be the most appropriate to define the capacity of the short-term memory.

- ☒ **A** 3 ± 2 digits
- ☒ **B** 5 ± 2 digits
- ☒ **C** 7 ± 2 digits
- ☒ **D** 9 ± 2 digits

(Total for Question 6 = 1 mark)

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Working and answer

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Practice workbook · Peterson and Peterson (1959): how long STM lasts

Procedure, findings and evaluation of the trigram short-term retention study.

7 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 6 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-MEM-06

1. Question 8 · part a · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

8 Chelsea was asked to go to the shop on Saturday by her mum to buy 10 items. She tried to remember the list of items by silently repeating them on the way to the shop.

On Sunday Chelsea was asked to go to the shop again by her mum to buy 10 different items. This time she tried to remember the list of items by saying them out loud to herself repeatedly on the way to the shop.

Chelsea remembered more of the items on the list when she went to the shop on Sunday.

(a) Explain why Chelsea remembered more items on Sunday.

You should refer to Peterson and Peterson (1959) in your answer.

(2)

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1. Question 8 · part a · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

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(b) Explain **two** weaknesses of using Peterson and Peterson (1959) to explain Chelsea's memory of the shopping lists.

(4)

Weakness 1

Weakness 2

(Total for Question 8 = 6 marks)

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1. Question 8 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

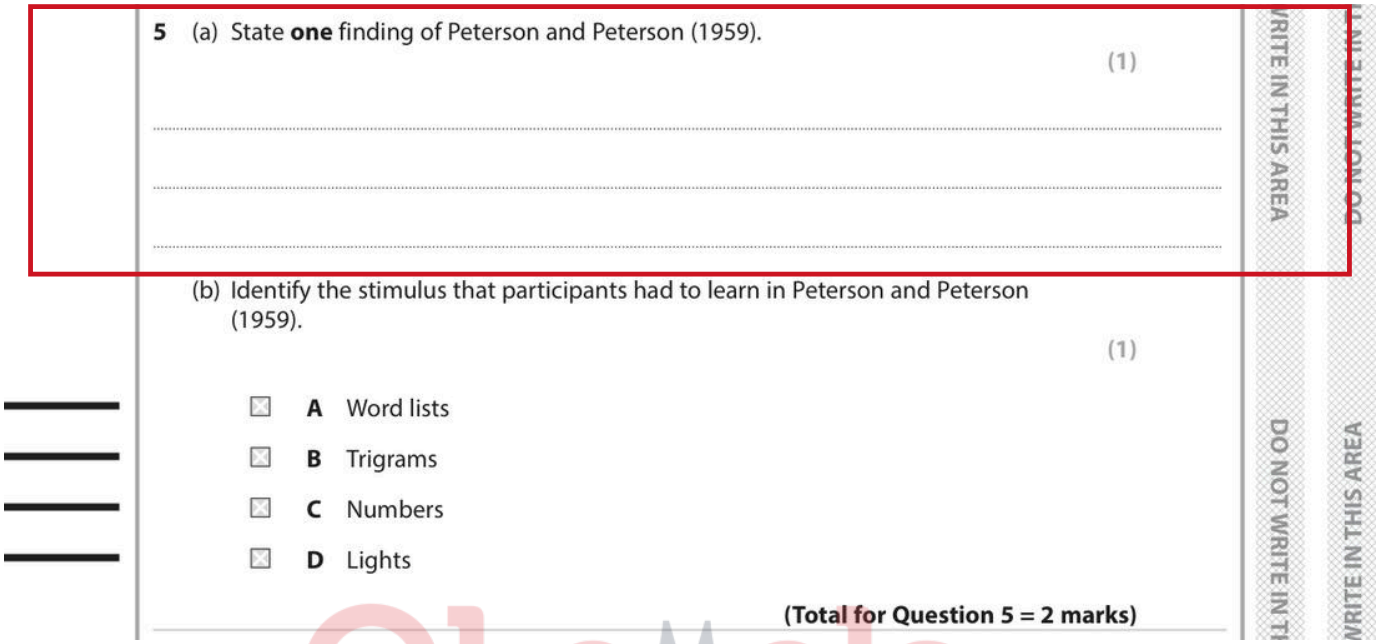
Working and answer

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2. Question 5 · part a · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.



5 (a) State **one** finding of Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

(b) Identify the stimulus that participants had to learn in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** Word lists
- ☒ **B** Trigrams
- ☒ **C** Numbers
- ☒ **D** Lights

(Total for Question 5 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

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3. Question 5 · part b · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

5 (a) State **one** finding of Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

(b) Identify the stimulus that participants had to learn in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** Word lists
- ☒ **B** Trigrams
- ☒ **C** Numbers
- ☒ **D** Lights

(Total for Question 5 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

4. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

8 Chelsea was asked to go to the shop on Saturday by her mum to buy 10 items. She tried to remember the list of items by silently repeating them on the way to the shop.

On Sunday Chelsea was asked to go to the shop again by her mum to buy 10 different items. This time she tried to remember the list of items by saying them out loud to herself repeatedly on the way to the shop.

Chelsea remembered more of the items on the list when she went to the shop on Sunday.

(a) Explain why Chelsea remembered more items on Sunday.

You should refer to Peterson and Peterson (1959) in your answer.

(2)

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4. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

(b) Explain **two** weaknesses of using Peterson and Peterson (1959) to explain Chelsea's memory of the shopping lists.

(4)

Weakness 1

Weakness 2

(Total for Question 8 = 6 marks)

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4. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 6 · part a · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

6 (a) Identify the recall intervals in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12 seconds
- ☒ **B** 3, 6, 9, 12, 15, 18 seconds
- ☒ **C** 4, 7, 10, 13, 16, 19 seconds
- ☒ **D** 5, 7, 9, 11, 13, 15 seconds

(b) Identify the numbers that participants counted back in before recalling information in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** 1s or 2s
- ☒ **B** 2s or 3s
- ☒ **C** 3s or 4s
- ☒ **D** 4s or 5s

(Total for Question 6 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

6. Question 6 · part b · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

6 (a) Identify the recall intervals in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12 seconds
- ☒ **B** 3, 6, 9, 12, 15, 18 seconds
- ☒ **C** 4, 7, 10, 13, 16, 19 seconds
- ☒ **D** 5, 7, 9, 11, 13, 15 seconds

(b) Identify the numbers that participants counted back in before recalling information in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

(1)

- ☒ **A** 1s or 2s
- ☒ **B** 2s or 3s
- ☒ **C** 3s or 4s
- ☒ **D** 4s or 5s

(Total for Question 6 = 2 marks)

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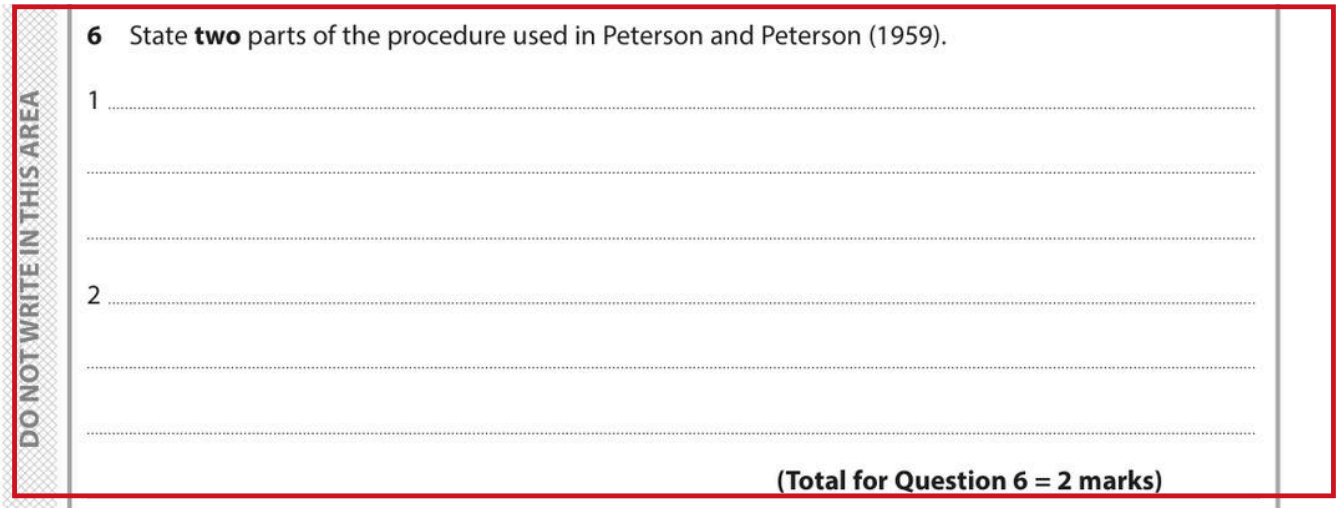
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Working and answer

7. Question 6 · part whole · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.


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6 State **two** parts of the procedure used in Peterson and Peterson (1959).

1 .....

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2 .....

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(Total for Question 6 = 2 marks)

Working and answer

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